

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 202

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Tennessee State University Speech and Debate Team for their exceptional performance at the Tennessee Forensics Association State Championship.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those outstanding collegians who bring honor to Tennessee as members of academic teams and act as ambassadors for our State through successful academic competition; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee State University (TSU) Speech and Debate Team is one such group of young people that has excelled in debate competition and solidified its reputation as one of the most competitive programs in the State; and

WHEREAS, the TSU Speech and Debate Team once again proved its dominance at the Tennessee Forensics Association State Championship, bringing home an impressive forty-three awards and seven state championship titles; and

WHEREAS, in addition to individual success, the team took second place in Individual Events Sweepstakes and second place overall in Team Sweepstakes; and

WHEREAS, junior Jared Howell showcased his exceptional debate skills at the State Championship, earning the title of state champion as the first-place speaker in Parliamentary Debate; his impressive performance also saw him advance to the semifinals in the event, further demonstrating his expertise in argumentation and critical thinking; and

WHEREAS, also leading the charge was junior Aaron Anderson, who claimed first place in Program Oral Interpretation, Prose Interpretation, and Pentathlon, along with top placements in multiple events; and

WHEREAS, sophomore Jocelyn Floyd took home first place in Informative Speaking for the second consecutive year, while De'Onta Newborn earned first place in Impromptu Speaking; Trinity Ancrum, who is a junior and first-year competitor, took first place in Poetry Interpretation, further showcasing the team's strength across multiple categories; and

WHEREAS, with another record-setting performance, the TSU Speech and Debate Team remains a powerhouse in the forensics community; the team next sets its sights on national competition, where it aims to build on its success as one of the leading programs in the nation; and

WHEREAS, the award-winning members of TSU Speech and Debate Team also include Mary Hooper, Chloe Spearmon, Jenny Miranda, Chardonnay Bowe, Amanda Perez, Alicia Trevino, Makayla Montgomery, Deja Thomas, Valeria Arredondo, Danae Jackson, Sylvia Johnson, and Destiny Irving; and

WHEREAS, the members of the TSU Speech and Debate Team demonstrated extraordinary intellect, preparation, and poise during the debate competition, bringing great pride to their families, their school, and the citizens of this great State; and

WHEREAS, this General Assembly finds it appropriate to pause in its deliberations to honor and congratulate these exemplary students on their many accomplishments; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the members of the Tennessee State University Speech and Debate Team for their exceptional performance at the Tennessee Forensics Association State Championship and extend to them our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.